CSP-EN-301 | CUSTOMER SPECIFICATION

Exterior Fascia Finish - Change Approval Rider

Customer change notice / finish appearance and post-cycle retention

Document	CSP-EN-301 / Issue A
Issued	20 October 2026
Customer owner	Vehicle Trim Materials Group
Covered supply	Production-equivalent multilayer finish on mild-steel witness panels
Acceptance status	Pre-production qualification / customer sign-off required

1. Background and release decision

Our styling group is willing to review the proposed replacement topcoat, but approval of the chemistry alone will not release the painted fascia parts. The concern is the narrow seam around the grille opening: several panels from the previous trial looked acceptable straight out of the oven and then lifted at the edge after repeated hot-to-cold storage. This notice is a customer acceptance condition for the new paint stack. Existing supplier process certificates may be included as supporting evidence, but the release panel must meet the results below.

2. Panel build and lot boundaries

Submit two independently mixed topcoat lots. From each lot, coat nine flat 100 × 200 mm steel witnesses using the same e-coat, primer and basecoat as the nominated part; assign three to baseline checks, three to thermal cycling and three to dispute retention. Record total dry film build and the separate topcoat thickness; the latter must be between 42 and 55 µm on every panel. Actual metal temperature, not oven setting, is the cure reference: 20 minutes at 140 ± 3 °C. Allow seven days at 23 ± 2 °C and 50 ± 5% RH before initial readings. Mark a repeatable five-position map on each panel.

3. What we mean by paint staying on the panel

We want a fine square scoring pattern made through the paint film, followed by the prescribed tape removal. For this grid-and-pull assessment the receiving site should use ISO 60038:2021. A North American supplier may request ASTM D1037-20 for the same paint-retention question, but must identify the cutting spacing, tape, scoring and rating scale before any results are compared. We are not declaring those two procedures interchangeable. Repeat the check both before and after five cycles between -20 °C for two hours and 70 °C for two hours, with a 30-minute room-temperature recovery between transfers.

4. Shine and shade after handling

We are also concerned about the bright strip visible at a low viewing angle. Record the 60° specular-gloss reading using ASTM D1627-16 at five marked locations. The arithmetic mean must be 82-92 GU as delivered; after cycling, each location must retain at least 90% of its own original value. Separately, compare the same panel with an untouched master under D65 lighting: the overall colour difference, calculated from measured L*, a* and b*, may not exceed 1.0. Measure colour difference by ISO 60570:2025 (COR-11) on the OEM steel finish; the master comparison and limit are buyer-specified.

5. Acceptance and evidence package

Any full flake lifting at a scored square, any cut-through to bare metal away from the intended score, or any site failing the approved adhesion rating is a lot failure. If the ISO procedure is used, only class 0 or 1 is acceptable; if an ASTM route is approved, our team will issue the corresponding acceptance class before testing. Report panel-level scores, photos of the grids, all gloss readings and the complete temperature-cycle record. Do not conceal a failed panel inside a passing batch average. Release requires written approval from Customer Materials Engineering.

Acceptance summary for the receiving report

Customer checkpoint	Release threshold
Topcoat film thickness	42-55 µm on each panel
Scored-grid retention	ISO class 0-1 before and after cycles
60° reflected gloss	82-92 GU initial; >=90% site retention
Master-panel colour drift	ΔE*ab <=1.0

For release review, the supplier must retain the recorded raw observations and submit any proposed deviations before testing. Only the customer-defined limits in this document govern this fictional purchase decision.

Prepared for synthetic extraction and normalization benchmarking. All customer entities, acceptance limits and cited test-method designations in this document are fictional; no method is asserted to be a published or officially equivalent standard.

Test-item bank alignment

COR-02 Cross-cut adhesion and COR-06 Specular gloss: cited in Sections 3-4.

COR-11 Colour difference: ISO 60570:2025 on OEM steel finish.

COR-04 Dry film thickness: ISO 60152:2025 on OEM steel finish.

All methods are synthetic; master-panel comparison and limits are buyer-set.